Pesto

Sauces & dips | Stovetop & prep

Before you start

Makes about 1 cup. Pack basil leaves, freshly grate cheese, and mince garlic. Use a food processor.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Basil and nuts for the first blend

- [ ] 2 cups fresh basil leaves, packed [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup freshly grated Parmesan-Reggiano or Romano cheese
- [ ] 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil
- [ ] 1/3 cup pine nuts or walnuts [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3 medium sized garlic cloves, minced
- [ ] Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste

1. Prepare and cook

1. Pulse 2 packed cups fresh basil and 1/3 cup pine nuts or walnuts in a food processor. If walnuts are whole, pulse them first before adding basil. Add 3 minced medium garlic cloves and pulse again.

2. With the processor running, slowly stream in 1/2 cup olive oil. Stop to scrape the sides. Add 1/2 cup grated Parmesan-Reggiano or Romano and pulse until blended. Season with salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste.

3. Serve with pasta, or over baked potatoes, or spread over toasted baguette slices.

4. Yield: Makes 1 cup.

Notes

The file also suggests trying the linked Serious Eats recipe; the saved ingredient quantities and method are retained here.